Coverage was graphic: you saw people dead and dying in the streets. The ramifications were horrifying. Indian TV anchors were blaming Pakistan for the terrorist outrage, which killed 170. Breaking news is the same the world over: it feeds off itself. What was going to happen next? There was talk of war and retaliation. It didn't seem right to be sitting there; we all had anxious conversations, reassuring loved ones back home.

We still had gear in the Taj Mahal, and pressure increased when reports emerged that terrorists originally planned their attack for earlier in the month, when we were staying there. They apparently abandoned a recce due to the intensity of the security. Understandably, we were ordered not to leave the surreal setting of our palm-fringed resort.

I felt for KP. His first tour as captain had been far from easy, even before he was subjected to the strains of an international incident that had political and diplomatic dimensions. Like most of the players, I wanted to take the common-sense option of leaving the country and allowing things to settle before deciding whether to resume the tour.

I was still relatively inexperienced, a little naïve in the ways of international sport. With the hindsight of my experience of captaining England, I can now appreciate the consideration given to the financial implications of cancellation by the respective cricket bodies in India and England. TV income was in jeopardy, and a Test tour was under threat. As a figurehead, KP would have been under pressure to take the party line.

KP addressed a team meeting and insisted we should stay. He argued that he wanted to do so because, as a fierce competitor and a proud captain, he hated the thought of being unable to stem a losing run. To be frank, in such a frenzied atmosphere, a lot of people didn't believe that. They wondered about a potentially ulterior motive, of maintaining popularity in India at a time in which the magnitude of the IPL was inescapable.

That competition could have been created for someone of KP's charisma and technical brilliance. He can be a compelling performer and knows how to play to a crowd. But, privately, he was struggling to sustain his authority. There was no overt hostility, but cricketers, like all athletes, are sensitive to mood. It probably wasn't the smartest thing to do, but Freddie called a team meeting from which the captain was excluded. He was insistent we should leave.

We departed after a two-day hiatus and spent four days at home before flying to Abu Dhabi while Reg assessed proposed Test venues in Chennai